

CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Customer Onboarding Playbook

Taking a new customer from "signed" to "fully live" in 30 days — the process that starts the day after the demo closes.

Day 0	Welcome and kickoff call
Week 1	Core setup
Week 2	Team enablement
Week 3	Marketing and reporting
Week 4	30-day check-in and handoff

No product or engineering background required to run this process.

Before you reach out

- Confirm the signed plan, seat count, and billing start date.
- Confirm whether they need HIPAA mode enabled and a business associate agreement signed — flag this immediately if so, it gates other work.
- Note anything promised during the sales process (a data migration, a custom field set, a specific integration) so onboarding doesn't miss it.
- Every new organization is created with sample leads, referrals, contacts, and a starter marketing campaign already loaded, so the account never opens empty. Plan to walk the customer through replacing that sample data with their own in week 1.

Day 0: Welcome and kickoff call

30 min

GOAL

The customer leaves this call knowing exactly what happens next and has already taken one real action in the account.

1. Send a welcome email same day as signing, with login instructions and the kickoff call booked — don't let momentum cool between contract and first touch.
2. On the call, confirm who on their side owns setup (usually the person who bought it isn't the person who'll configure it — get the actual admin's name).
3. Walk through the sample data already in their account and explain it's there to show the shape of things, not to keep — "this is what a lead looks like, we'll replace these three with your real ones this week."
4. Set expectations for the next 30 days: a short list of milestones (team invited, real data in, first week live, 30-day check-in), not a wall of detail.
5. End with one concrete task before the call ends: invite one teammate, or add one real lead. Getting a second click in during the call beats any number of "I'll do it later" promises.

Week 1: Core setup

This is the highest-dropout week — if the account isn't configured to match how the customer actually works by day 7, adoption stalls. Prioritize in this order:

1. **Team invited.** Get every day-one user invited and logged in, with the right role assigned (owner, admission manager, or liaison). Don't wait for "the full team" — invite whoever needs access this week and add stragglers later.
2. **Fields match their process.** Review the default lead and referral fields against how they actually track things. Add, rename, or remove fields so the board reflects their process, not a generic template. Remind them this takes seconds, no ticket required.
3. **Pipeline stages match their language.** Update the default stage names (New, Contacted, Qualified, Proposal, Won, Lost) to whatever they actually call each stage internally.
4. **Real data replaces sample data.** Either bulk-import their existing spreadsheet through the import screen, or delete the sample leads and referrals once real ones are flowing in. Don't leave both sitting side by side past week 1 — it muddies their first reports.
5. **Territory/county setup**, if they route work geographically — add their real counties or regions and assign the right person to each.

Week 2: Team enablement and daily workflow

1. Run one short training session (15-20 min, screen share) for the staff who'll use the board daily — inline editing, adding a lead, moving a stage, using filters. Keep it hands-on, not a feature tour.
2. Confirm calendar is connected for anyone who needs it (Google or Outlook), and that their public booking page reflects real availability if they plan to use it.
3. If they log mileage or expenses, get one real entry into each log type during this week so the habit starts early, not at month-end when totals are due.
4. Check in async (not another meeting) — a short message asking "anything confusing so far?" catches friction before it becomes a support ticket.

Week 3: Marketing and reporting, if applicable

Only run this section for customers actually planning to use these features — don't push it on everyone by default.

1. If they'll send email campaigns, they need to connect their own mailbox (Gmail or Outlook) or verify a sending domain before anything can actually send — flag this early since domain verification takes time.
2. Review the intake form and landing page that come pre-loaded, and swap the sample copy for their real messaging if they intend to publish either one.
3. Walk through the analytics dashboards together once there's a real week of data behind them — this is more convincing with their numbers than a demo's sample numbers ever was.

Week 4: 30-day check-in

1. Send a short survey or hold a 15-minute call: are they hitting the milestones set on day 0? What's still confusing?
2. Pull real usage: are the day-one invited users actually logging in? A customer with zero weekly logins after 30 days is a churn risk, not a slow starter — escalate internally, don't wait for a renewal conversation to surface it.
3. Confirm billing matches actual seat count — team size often changes in the first month.
4. Formally close out onboarding: tell them who to contact going forward (support portal, not you personally) and mark the account as live.

Roles and handoff

Onboarding owner

Runs the kickoff, checks in through day 30, and is the single point of contact until handoff.

Customer's admin

The person who actually configures fields, invites the team, and owns day-to-day account decisions — identify this person on the kickoff call, not after.

Support handoff

Once the 30-day check-in is complete, hand the customer to the support portal for ongoing questions. Tell them this explicitly — a customer who keeps emailing their onboarding contact after handoff is a sign the handoff wasn't communicated clearly.

Signs onboarding is off track

WATCH FOR

- No login from the admin within 48 hours of the welcome email.
- Sample data still untouched by the end of week 1.
- Nobody invited beyond the original signer by week 2.
- Silence after a check-in message — a quiet account is not a fine account.

Any one of these is worth a direct phone call, not another email.

Exit criteria — when onboarding is done

- ✓ Real data has replaced the sample leads and referrals.
- ✓ Every day-one user has logged in at least once.
- ✓ Pipeline stages and fields match how the customer actually works.
- ✓ The 30-day check-in happened and usage looks healthy.
- ✓ The customer knows where to go for help next (support portal, not you).

Once all five are true, close onboarding and move the account to standard support.